

Three films, one RTX 5090

A walkthrough of the comfy-studio pipeline: what was used for every shot, and why. Every frame was made on one local graphics card with open-weight models; nothing was paid for. The shots we would have sent to Seedance 2.5, and the exact prompts, are in section 6.



DEAD STOCK

A courier cornered in a warehouse at night brings the stock down between herself and the man sent to collect it.



HOUSE RULES

At three in the morning a soaked stranger walks into a roadside diner, and the waitress remembers him before he says who he is.



TEMPER

One night at the forge: fire, hammer, water, and a blade that holds its edge.

film	runtime	shots	takes rendered	engines in the cut
DEAD STOCK	58 s	12	51	Blender previz + LTX-2.3 depth control, LTX-2.5, MiniMax H3
HOUSE RULES	58 s	11	36	LTX-2.5, MiniMax H3
TEMPER	54 s	11	48	LTX-2.5, MiniMax H3

What is in this document. 1 - the pipeline, stage by stage, and why each stage is there. 2-4 - the three films, shot by shot: the start frame, the engine, the take that went in and the numbers that put it there. 5 - the start-frame compositor contest, run on every shot. 6 - H3 against LTX-2.5 on the same frames. 7 - the Seedance notation. 8 - what was deliberately not used. 9 - what it cost in minutes. 10 - how to make them again.

The films. Each comes three ways: *_final_2x.mp4* (2560x1408, the master), *_final.mp4* (1280x704) and *_annotated.mp4*, which captions every shot with the engine that drew it, what its start frame was composed with, the take and why it was picked - and marks in amber the shots we would have sent to Seedance. *dead-stock_physics_side_by_side.mp4* shows the Blender simulation beside the shot it drove.

1 The pipeline

The films were made the way the paid breakdowns make a sequence - pictures first, a composed start frame per shot, one beat per shot, sound written in, a pick by measurement, one grade at the finish - with the engine swapped for local weights and every choice measured. It runs from one file per film (a shot script) through studio/_tools/fight.py, which is also the /shots page of the studio app.

stage	what did it	why
Shot script	one JSON per film: cast, place, shots, prompts, engine per shot, the line each take must say, the Seedance note	The story as data: the same tool builds any film, and every decision below is recorded.
Cast and plate	Flux 2 text-to-image (workflow 40): each person full-length on grey; the place wide and empty	Refs before words: a character is described once, then every shot points at the picture.
Start frames	BOTH Flux 2 with three chained references (75) and Qwen-Image-2.1 with its reference edit (80, two seeds); every face scored against the cast; best kept	The start frame decides where a shot begins, who is in it and what it looks like. Qwen won the 09-27 A/B on one shot; tonight it ran on every shot (section 5).
Takes	LTX-2.5 (70) by default; MiniMax H3 (67) for effects and close sound; both where it was a toss-up; Blender previz + LTX-2.3 depth control (74) for the physical beat	Each engine where it is measurably best (playbook \$96.5, \$98.3-98.4, review \$0.2). Three seeds a shot is the floor for a pick.
The pick	take_rank.py: each face on the last frame against the same face in the start frame; each line through a local speech model; level; camera against the ask	One rule for every shot: a fault blocks a pick, a note never does; the highest score among the unfaulted takes goes in.
Music	ACE-Step (06): two cues from the script's score tags, crossfaded	ACE-Step fades out past about 45 s; two cues make an act break instead of a fade.
Finish	audio conformed, cut, one film grade, the score under at half level, loudness to -16 LUFS, the frame count checked against the takes, a 2x master, title card	The finish is half the film; the frame-count check is how a dropped or doubled frame is caught.

2 DEAD STOCK

A courier cornered in a warehouse at night brings the stock down between herself and the man sent to collect it.

58 seconds, 12 shots. Demo film 1 of 3 (2026-09-29). Action, built around a physical beat choreographed in Blender (studio/_tools/previz_shot.py) instead of hoped for from words.



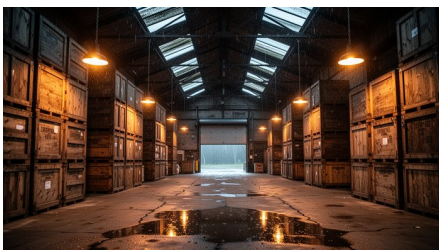
The cast and the place, made first: nadia (the courier), hale (the collector); and the warehouse. Every later picture of them is drawn from these.

Look, negative and score

Grade (appended to every start frame, applied once at the finish): Cinematic film, night, sodium-orange practical lamps against cold blue-green shadow, wet reflective concrete, haze in the air, deep blacks with detail, fine grain, anamorphic.

Score - cue one: dark cinematic tension score, low pulsing synth bass, sustained low strings, soft ticking percussion, slow build, suspense, instrumental, no vocals. Cue two: cinematic aftermath, low strings swell and fall away, a few sparse piano notes, distant thunder, quiet, instrumental, no vocals.

Shot by shot



010 the warehouse - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 3003. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: the place's plate itself - nobody in the shot, nothing to compose

The take: camera: push in 36%; level -32 dB. Picked: by eye over the ranker's 11 - a steady push-in with no tilt (seed 11 tilts down 10% as it pushes 52%) (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: Nothing moves in the empty warehouse but the weather and the light: rain streams down the skylights, one hanging sodium lamp sways slightly on its chain so its pool of orange light drifts across the wet floor, drops fall from the roof into a puddle and ripple the reflection. Nobody is here. The camera pushes in slowly and steadily down the aisle. Heavy rain drumming on the roof, the electrical hum of the lamps, dripping water. No music.



020 hiding - 4 s

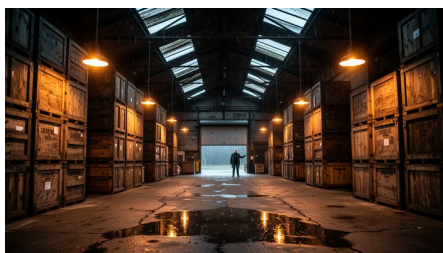
Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 11. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.41; Qwen ss11 0.49; Qwen ss202 0.52 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame nadia 0.77; camera: static; level -47 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.772 (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 3003) scored 0.733.



Prompt: She holds her breath and listens, her eyes moving toward the aisle, then lets the breath out slowly through her mouth, very quietly. She does not move from the crates. Handheld camera close, a faint float, almost still. Her shallow breathing, rain drumming on the roof far above, a distant drip. No music.



030 the door - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux n/a; Qwen ss11 n/a; Qwen ss202 n/a (no face to score - default).

The take: camera: push in 21%; level -29 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: The man in the doorway lets go of the door frame and takes one slow step into the warehouse, out of the rain, and stops, looking down the aisle. Rain blows in around him. Static camera. The heavy loading door creaking on its rails, rain roaring outside, one footstep on wet concrete. No music.

Seedance candidate. A walk. Measured: our engines hold the picture and the person but not the walk itself - he takes one step and stops because we wrote it that way. Seedance would walk him the whole aisle. The prompt we did not send is in section 6.



040 the offer - 6 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 202. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.46; Qwen ss11 0.56; Qwen ss202 0.52 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame hale 0.74; line heard 100% ("it's only a bag nadia put it down and walk out of here"); camera: tilt up 6%; level -18 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.991 (3 takes rendered).

The line: "It's only a bag, Nadia. Put it down and walk out of here."



Prompt: He speaks calmly and quietly, in a low, rough, unhurried voice: "It's only a bag, Nadia. Put it down and walk out of here." Then he waits, very still. Static camera, a faint handheld float. His voice echoing in the big space, rain on the roof, the hum of the lamp. No music.



050 the stack - 5 s

Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 202. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.31; Qwen ss11 0.48; Qwen ss202 0.46 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame nadia 0.62; camera: static; level -46 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.622 (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 3003) scored 0.465; faults: face drifted (0.47 against its start frame).



Prompt: Her eyes open and she slowly tilts her head back to look straight up at the top of the tall stack of crates she is leaning on; her jaw sets. Handheld camera close, almost still. Her breath, rain far above, a loose strap tapping against wood. No music.



060 the strap - 4 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.46; Qwen ss11 0.54; Qwen ss202 0.58 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame nadia 0.71; camera: push in 11%, tilt up 6%; level -18 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.714 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: She throws her whole weight back on the strap; it snaps taut and the tower of crates above her groans and begins to tilt. Handheld camera, a faint float. The strap creaking, wood groaning and cracking, rain far above. No music.



070 the fall - 5 s

Engine: Blender previz + LTX-2.3 depth control, seed 3003. A physical event with dozens of bodies in contact. The motion was simulated in Blender, and the video engine only painted over the simulation's depth, so every crate lands where the physics put it.

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 dressing the first frame of the Blender simulation (see the physics page)

The take: camera: push in 18%; level -19 dB. Picked: by eye over the ranker's pv:11 - a plume of dust bursts at the impact; the same motion agreement with the simulation as seed 11 (r 0.918) (5 takes rendered).



Prompt: Inside a vast dark warehouse at night under hanging sodium lamps, a towering stack of old wooden shipping crates topples across the aisle; the crates crash onto the wet concrete, burst apart and tumble, piling up into a wall of broken wood that blocks the aisle, splinters and dust thrown up into the orange lamplight. Far down the aisle a man in a long dark coat stands still. The camera drifts slowly. Sound: a deep groan of wood, then a thunderous crash and clatter of crates, splintering boards, debris settling, rain on the roof. No music.

Seedance candidate. A physical event with dozens of bodies in contact. We choreographed it in Blender and drew it through depth control, so every crate lands where the simulation put it; Seedance would invent the physics from words - better texture at speed, no guarantee where anything lands. The prompt we did not send is in section 6.



080 the dust - 4 s

Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 202. An effects beat: on LTX-2.5 dust accumulates whatever the words say; on H3 it plateaus and clears (measured, \$98.3-98.4), so this shot was rendered on H3 only.

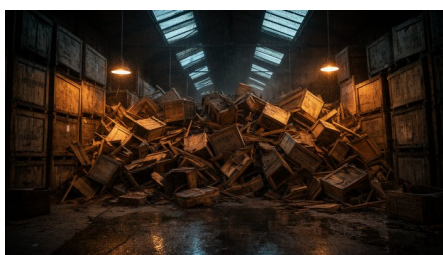
Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.50; Qwen ss11 0.66; Qwen ss202 0.62 (override).

The take: face against its own start frame hale 0.70; camera: static; level -21 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.704 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: The dust cloud rolls over him and thins; he slowly lowers his arm and squints ahead through the settling dust. Static camera. Debris settling and pattering, a last board clattering down, his cough, rain. No music.

Seedance candidate. An effect that must arrive at an instant and then clear (the breakdown's rule 3). Measured: LTX lets dust accumulate whatever the words say; H3 plateaus and clears, which is why this shot is on H3. Seedance keys the effect to the impact frame. The prompt we did not send is in section 6.



090 the wall - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux n/a; Qwen ss11 n/a; Qwen ss202 n/a (no face to score - default).

The take: camera: push in 13%; level -24 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: Nothing moves but the settling dust drifting through the lamplight and one loose board that slides down the pile and clatters onto the floor. Nobody is here. Static camera. Dust hissing down, the board's clatter, rain on the roof, the lamps' hum. No music.



100 fine - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 7. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.40; Qwen ss11 0.51; Qwen ss202 0.51 (highest face score).

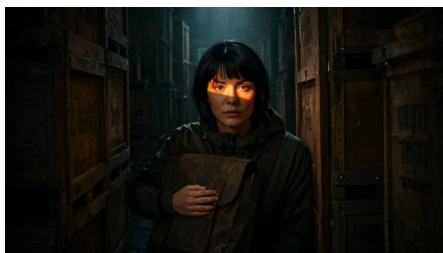
The take: face against its own start frame hale 0.66; line heard 100% ("fine run then"); camera: static; level -23 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.907 (7 takes rendered).

The line: "Fine. Run, then."

Note: Re-directed 2026-09-29: all three takes of prompt_v1 turned 'the faintest smile' into a full grin; the smile was taken out of the words and four more seeds rendered. Seeds 11/202/3003 are prompt_v1, 5150/7/8801/9090 this prompt.



Prompt: He stares ahead, unreadable, and says quietly, in a low, rough voice: "Fine. Run, then." His face barely moves; only his eyes narrow a little. Static camera, a faint float. His voice, dust pattering, rain. No music.

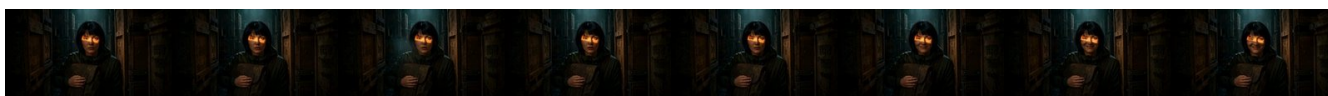


110 the other side - 6 s

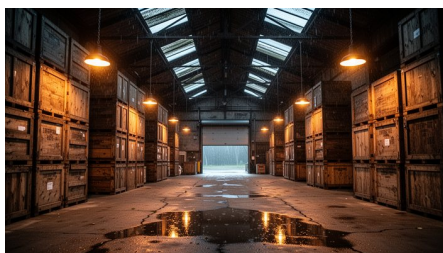
Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 11. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.40; Qwen ss11 0.43; Qwen ss202 0.41 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame nadia 0.62; camera: static; level -56 dB. Picked: every take faulted; fewest faults (silent (-56 dB)) (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 3003) scored 0.442; faults: face drifted (0.49 against its start frame).



Prompt: She listens, completely still, then lets out a long breath, and the ghost of a smile crosses her face. Handheld camera close, almost still. Her breath, dust settling, rain far above. No music.



120 lights out - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 3003. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: the place's plate itself - nobody in the shot, nothing to compose

The take: camera: push in 8%; level -35 dB. Picked: by eye over the ranker's 11 - the lamps hold a beat before they die; in seed 11 they go out in the first frames (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: Nothing moves in the empty warehouse but the lamps: the nearest hanging sodium lamp sways slowly on its chain, flickers twice and goes out, leaving only the cold blue light from the skylights and the rain. Nobody is here. Static camera. Rain on the roof, the lamp's buzzing hum and the click as it dies. No music.

The physics shot: choreograph, dress, draw

DEAD STOCK's collapse is the one shot in these films whose motion was not written in words. A tall stack of eighteen crates is pushed over across the aisle in Blender 5.2 with rigid-body physics; the simulation says the top crate comes down at frame 23 of 113. Its first frame is then dressed as the film by Qwen-Image-2.1 (the simulation as the canvas, the warehouse plate and the collector as further references), and LTX-2.3 with the IC-LoRA union control reads the simulation's depth and paints the real scene over it. The engine paints; the physics moves.



the Blender simulation (proxy boxes, a proxy figure)



its first frame dressed by Qwen-Image-2.1



the take in the film (Blender previz + LTX-2.3 depth control, seed 3003)



Blender 5.2 - rigid-body simulation, proxy boxes

LTX-2.3 + IC-LoRA depth control - the take in the film

Two seconds in, frame for frame: the simulation (left) and the take in the film (right). The clip is dead-stock_physics_side_by_side.mp4.

take	start frame	motion agreement with the simulation (r)	seconds
pv_070_s11.mp4	dressed frame	0.918	54.4
pv_070_s202.mp4	dressed frame	0.846	42.2
pv_070_s3003.mp4	dressed frame	0.918	42.2
pvb_070_s11.mp4	none (bypassed)	0.962	42.1
pvb_070_s202.mp4	none (bypassed)	0.934	42.1

Motion agreement is the Pearson correlation between the simulation's frame-to-frame motion energy and the render's, over the whole clip: 1.0 moves exactly when the simulation moves.

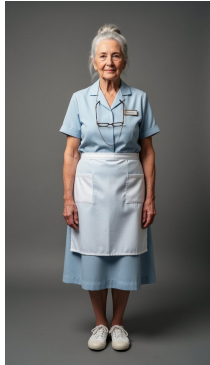
What the two arms say. Without a start frame the render follows the simulation even more closely (r 0.96 / 0.93) - nothing competes with the depth guide - but it invents its own room, lit its own way, and cannot be cut into the film. With the dressed start frame (r 0.92 / 0.85 / 0.92) the warehouse is the film's warehouse and the collector is

the collector. On 2026-09-27, with no start frame and a ball-and-crates previz, the same route measured r 0.84 / 0.71.

3 HOUSE RULES

At three in the morning a soaked stranger walks into a roadside diner, and the waitress remembers him before he says who he is.

58 seconds, 11 shots. Demo film 2 of 3 (2026-09-29). Dialogue: five spoken lines lip-synced on LTX-2.5, one room, two faces held across cuts by composed start frames.



The cast and the place, made first: iris (the waitress), theo (the stranger); and the diner. Every later picture of them is drawn from these.

Look, negative and score

Grade (appended to every start frame, applied once at the finish): Cinematic film, three in the morning, warm tungsten light inside against the cold blue rain outside, red and green neon reflections on wet glass and chrome, soft haze, deep blacks with detail, fine grain, anamorphic.

Score - cue one: sparse late-night solo piano, soft upright bass, very quiet brushed drums, warm, melancholic, tender, slow, instrumental, no vocals. Cue two: solo piano, gentle warm resolution, soft strings enter under it, hopeful, tender, slow, instrumental, no vocals.

Shot by shot



010 open all night - 5 s

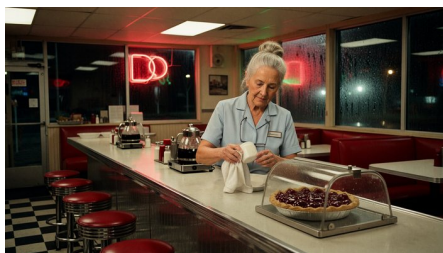
Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: the place's plate itself - nobody in the shot, nothing to compose

The take: camera: push in 39%; level -37 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: Nothing moves in the empty diner but the weather and the light: rain streams down the big windows, the neon glow outside flickers on the wet glass, a thread of steam rises from the coffee pot on its warmer. Nobody is here. The camera pushes in slowly along the counter. Rain against the windows, the buzz of the neon sign, the hum of a refrigerator. No music.



020 the bell - 4 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.37; Qwen ss11 0.54; Qwen ss202 0.43 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame iris 0.65; camera: push in 12%; level -32 dB. Picked: by eye over the ranker's 202 - she looks up from the cup toward the bell as written; the top-scoring seed 202 never lifts her head (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: The little bell over the door jingles; she looks up from the cup toward the sound and her hands stop. Static camera, a faint handheld float. The bell's jingle, a gust of rain noise from the door, then the rain muffled again. No music.



030 the stranger - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 3003. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.65; Qwen ss11 0.69; Qwen ss202 0.70 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame theo 0.65; camera: static; level -48 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.654 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: He stands dripping just inside the door and hesitates; he pushes the wet hair off his forehead with one hand and looks toward the counter. Static camera. Water dripping onto the floor mat, the door easing shut behind him, the rain outside muffled. No music.

Seedance candidate. The only candidate in this film, and a weak one: an entrance is a walk, and our engines hold the walker rather than the walk - so he is already inside when the shot begins. Dialogue, faces and a room at night are what this box does best; nothing else here needs paying for. The prompt we did not send is in section 6.



040 coffee - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 3003. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.53; Qwen ss11 0.50; Qwen ss202 0.66 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame theo 0.65, iris 0.73; camera: static; level -46 dB. Picked: by eye over the ranker's 11 - the steam the prompt asks for is visibly curling up between them; both faces hold (0.65, 0.73) (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: She pours hot coffee into his cup and steam curls up between them in the warm light; he wraps both hands around it. Neither of them speaks. Static camera. Coffee pouring into the cup, the pot set down on the steel counter, rain on the windows. No music.



050 I can pay - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

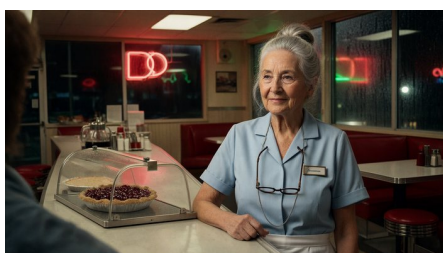
Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.60; Qwen ss11 0.60; Qwen ss202 0.55 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame theo 0.71; line heard 100% ("i can pay for it."); camera: push in 28%, tilt up 11%; level -32 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.911 (3 takes rendered).

The line: "I can pay for it."



Prompt: He sets the coins down on the counter one by one and pushes them forward, not quite meeting her eyes, and says quietly, in a soft, hoarse young man's voice: "I can pay for it." Static camera, a faint float. The coins clicking on steel, his voice, the rain. No music.



060 house rules - 6 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 202. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.56; Qwen ss11 0.62; Qwen ss202 0.63 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame iris 0.58; line heard 100% ("coffee's free after three love house rules"); camera: static; level -23 dB. Picked: every take faulted; fewest faults (face drifted (0.58 against its start frame)) (3 takes rendered).

The line: "Coffee's free after three, love. House rules."



Prompt: She slides the coins back across the counter with two fingers and says, in a warm, low, slightly husky older woman's voice: "Coffee's free after three, love. House rules." Static camera, a faint float. The coins sliding on steel, her voice, the rain on the windows. No music.



070 you don't remember - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

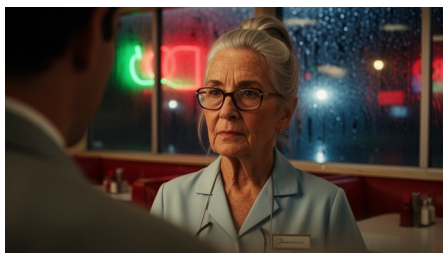
Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.41; Qwen ss11 0.53; Qwen ss202 0.45 (override).

The take: face against its own start frame theo 0.62; line heard 100% ("you don't remember me"); camera: static; level -32 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.871 (3 takes rendered).

The line: "You don't remember me."



Prompt: He looks at her for a long moment, then says quietly, in a soft, hoarse young man's voice: "You don't remember me." Static camera, a faint float. His voice, the rain, the refrigerator's hum. No music.



080 yellow raincoat - 7 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 202. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

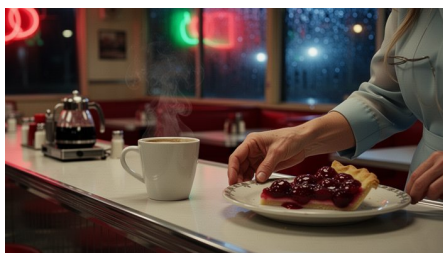
Start frame: Flux 2 (three references, workflow 75), seed 4242. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.53; Qwen ss11 0.64; Qwen ss202 0.63 (override).

The take: face against its own start frame iris 0.69; line heard 86% ("yellow rain mote cherry pie you were seven"); camera: static; level -24 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.903 (3 takes rendered).

The line: "Yellow raincoat. Cherry pie. You were seven."



Prompt: She takes her reading glasses off slowly and looks at him properly; her face softens and she says, in a warm, low, slightly husky older woman's voice: "Yellow raincoat. Cherry pie. You were seven." Static camera, a faint float. Her voice, the rain, the neon buzz. No music.



090 the pie - 4 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Flux 2 (three references, workflow 75), seed 4242. Faces against the cast: Flux n/a; Qwen ss11 n/a; Qwen ss202 n/a (override).

The take: camera: push in 24%, tilt down 7%; level -36 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: Her hand sets the plate down beside the cup, gives it a small push forward, and withdraws. Static camera, close. The plate touching down on steel, the rain. No music.



100 he laughs - 5 s

Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 202. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.62; Qwen ss11 0.68; Qwen ss202 0.66 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame theo 0.61; camera: static; level -41 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.612 (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 11) scored 0.413; faults: face drifted (0.41 against its start frame).



Prompt: His eyes fill; he laughs once, softly, through his nose, and wipes his eye with the heel of his hand, smiling down at the counter. Static camera, a faint float. His soft breath of a laugh, the rain, the neon buzz. No music.



110 last orders - 7 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux n/a; Qwen ss11 n/a; Qwen ss202 n/a (no face to score - default).

The take: camera: static; level -39 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (3 takes rendered).

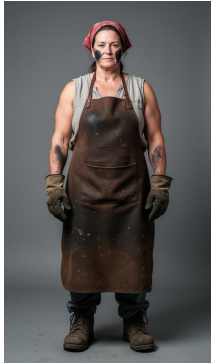


Prompt: She leans on the counter across from him while he eats; she refills his cup, and they both laugh at something. Static camera. The low murmur of their voices too quiet to make out, rain on the windows, the neon buzz. No music.

4 TEMPER

One night at the forge: fire, hammer, water, and a blade that holds its edge.

54 seconds, 11 shots. Demo film 3 of 3 (2026-09-29). Texture: fire, sparks and steam. Effects beats rendered on H3 and LTX both and picked by measurement; one multishot generation with internal cuts.



The cast and the place, made first: maren (the smith); and the forge. Every later picture of them is drawn from these.

Look, negative and score

Grade (appended to every start frame, applied once at the finish): Cinematic film, night, deep orange firelight against cool blue moonlight from an open doorway, glowing embers, drifting smoke haze, rich blacks with detail, fine grain, anamorphic.

Score - cue one: slow cinematic build, deep taiko drums, low droning cello, metallic percussion like distant anvils, dark, epic, instrumental, no vocals. Cue two: cinematic climax and release, full low strings and pounding taiko, then a single long sustained string note fading, instrumental, no vocals.

Shot by shot



010 the forge - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: the place's plate itself - nobody in the shot, nothing to compose

The take: camera: push in 154%, pan left 29%, tilt down 9%; level -42 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: Nothing moves in the empty forge but the fire: the bed of coals glows and pulses, small flames lick up and die back, sparks drift up into the hood, smoke curls along the rafters. Nobody is here. The camera pushes in slowly toward the hearth. The low roar of the fire, crackling coals, a distant owl. No music.



020 bellows - 4 s

Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 202. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux n/a; Qwen ss11 n/a; Qwen ss202 n/a (no face to score - default).

The take: camera: static; level -17 dB. Picked: by eye over the ranker's h3:11 - two separate flares, one per pump, each dying before the next - the effect at the instant the prompt asks for; the LTX takes grow the fire and keep it (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 11) scored 0.700.



Prompt: The gloved hand pumps the bellows down hard twice; at each breath of air the coals flare white-hot and a spray of sparks leaps up into the hood. Static camera, close. The deep whoosh of the bellows, the fire roaring up, sparks crackling. No music.



030 watching - 5 s

Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 202. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Flux 2 (three references, workflow 75), seed 4242. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.52; Qwen ss11 0.43; Qwen ss202 0.49 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame maren 0.64; camera: static; level -45 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.641 (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 202) scored 0.469; faults: face drifted (0.47 against its start frame).



Prompt: She watches the fire without blinking; the glow pulses across her face, and a bead of sweat runs down her temple. Handheld camera close, almost still. The roar of the fire, crackling coals, her slow breath. No music.



040 the blade - 4 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 202. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux n/a; Qwen ss11 n/a; Qwen ss202 n/a (no face to score - default).

The take: camera: static; level -30 dB. Picked: by eye over the ranker's 11 - a static camera on the glowing blade drawn from the coals; the ranker default rolls the camera 5 degrees (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: The tongs draw the long blade out of the coals; it glows bright orange-yellow along its whole length and sheds sparks as it comes. Static camera, close. Steel scraping over coals, the fire's crackle and roar. No music.



050 first blow - 5 s

Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 202. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.63; Qwen ss11 0.75; Qwen ss202 0.71 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame maren 0.62; camera: static; level -26 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.625 (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 3003) scored 0.453; faults: face drifted (0.45 against its start frame).



Prompt: She brings the hammer down on the glowing blade, once, twice, three times; at each blow a burst of bright sparks sprays off the anvil and dies away. Static camera. The ringing clang of the hammer on hot steel at each blow, the fire roaring behind her. No music.

Seedance candidate. Sparks that exist at the instant of each blow and are gone before the next - the breakdown's rule 3, which we measured does not transfer to LTX-2.5 (the effect accumulates) and partly does to H3. This shot is rendered on both and picked; Seedance is the engine that keys an effect to an impact frame. The prompt we did not send is in section 6.

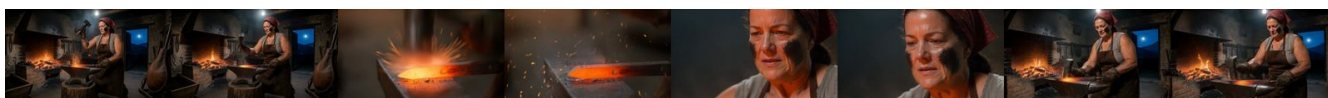


060 the rhythm - 8 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 3003. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.44; Qwen ss11 0.70; Qwen ss202 0.68 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame maren 0.61; camera: roll -4.3 deg; level -29 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.610 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: She hammers the glowing blade in a steady rhythm, sparks flying at every blow. Cut to a close-up of the hammer striking the orange steel on the anvil in a burst of sparks. Cut to a close-up of her face, sweat and firelight, eyes on the work. Cut back to her at the anvil as she turns the blade with the tongs and strikes again. Static camera in every shot. The ringing rhythm of the hammer, the roar of the fire, her breath. No music.

Seedance candidate. Several angles on fast repeated strikes in one generation. LTX-2.5 does the cuts (measured: the word cut makes the cut, and the face holds when it is in the start frame) but not the speed of the swing; Seedance's 15-second multi-shot with references is built for exactly this. The prompt we did not send is in section 6.



070 quench - 4 s

Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 11. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Flux 2 (three references, workflow 75), seed 4242. Faces against the cast: Flux n/a; Qwen ss11 n/a; Qwen ss202 n/a (override).

The take: camera: static; level -38 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 11) scored 0.700.



Prompt: The glowing blade plunges into the water; the water boils violently around it and a thick cloud of white steam bursts up and rolls away across the frame. Static camera, close. A loud angry hiss and bubbling, then the steam's fading sigh. No music.

Seedance candidate. A burst of steam at the instant of contact that must then roll away and clear - rule 3 again. Rendered here on H3 and LTX and picked. The prompt we did not send is in section 6.



080 through the steam - 5 s

Engine: MiniMax H3, seed 202. Rendered on both engines and picked by measurement: H3 keeps the composed start frame almost exactly and returns louder close sound; LTX-2.5 moves more freely. The take that scored best against its own start frame went in.

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.57; Qwen ss11 0.67; Qwen ss202 0.70 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame maren 0.65; camera: push in 51%, tilt up 21%; level -41 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.653 (6 takes rendered). The best take on the other engine (LTX-2.5, 202) scored 0.514; faults: face drifted (0.51 against its start frame).



Prompt: The steam thins around her; she raises the dark blade to eye level and sights down its edge, turning it slowly in the firelight. Handheld camera, a faint float. The last hiss of steam, the fire's low roar. No music.



090 the edge - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 202. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s202. Faces against the cast: Flux 0.46; Qwen ss11 0.45; Qwen ss202 0.63 (highest face score).

The take: face against its own start frame maren 0.77; camera: push in 30%, tilt up 15%; level -43 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.723 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: She turns the blade a little so the firelight runs along its edge like a line of light; the ghost of a satisfied smile. Static camera, a faint float. The fire crackling low, her slow breath out. No music.



100 hang the hammer - 6 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 11. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: Qwen-Image-2.1 (reference edit, workflow 80), seed s11. Faces against the cast: Flux n/a; Qwen ss11 n/a; Qwen ss202 n/a (no face to score - default).

The take: camera: push in 16%; level -33 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: She hangs the hammer on its hook and stands for a moment looking at the fire burning down, the blade in her hand. Static camera. The hammer's clink on the hook, the fire crackling low, an owl outside. No music.



110 embers - 5 s

Engine: LTX-2.5, seed 202. LTX-2.5 is the default engine: one sampling pass holds the scene, sound is generated with the picture, and a written line is lip-synced through a mouth on screen (playbook \$96.5).

Start frame: the place's plate itself - nobody in the shot, nothing to compose

The take: camera: push in 20%; level -42 dB. Picked: no faults, highest score 0.700 (3 takes rendered).



Prompt: Nothing moves in the empty forge but the dying fire: the coals fade from orange to a dull red glow, a last thin curl of smoke rises into the hood, and the moonlight lies still in the doorway. Nobody is here. Static camera. The faint tick and crackle of cooling coals, the night outside. No music.

5 The start-frame contest, on every shot

On 2026-09-27 Qwen-Image-2.1 beat Flux 2 as the start-frame compositor on one shot (a tie on one face, +0.09 on the other) and the rule said: keep Flux 2 until it holds on a second shot. Tonight every composed start frame was drawn by both - Flux 2 once, Qwen-2.1 on two seeds - and every face scored against its character's reference. This is that second shot, thirty times over.

film	shot	Flux 2	Qwen s11	Qwen s202	kept	why
DEAD STOCK	020	0.41	0.49	0.52	Qwen s202	highest face score
DEAD STOCK	030	-	-	-	Qwen s11	no face to score - default
DEAD STOCK	040	0.46	0.56	0.52	Qwen s11	highest face score
DEAD STOCK	050	0.31	0.48	0.46	Qwen s11	highest face score
DEAD STOCK	060	0.46	0.54	0.58	Qwen s202	highest face score
DEAD STOCK	080	0.50	0.66	0.62	Qwen s202	override
DEAD STOCK	090	-	-	-	Qwen s11	no face to score - default
DEAD STOCK	100	0.40	0.51	0.51	Qwen s11	highest face score
DEAD STOCK	110	0.40	0.43	0.41	Qwen s11	highest face score
HOUSE RULES	020	0.37	0.54	0.43	Qwen s11	highest face score
HOUSE RULES	030	0.65	0.69	0.70	Qwen s202	highest face score
HOUSE RULES	040	0.53	0.50	0.66	Qwen s202	highest face score
HOUSE RULES	050	0.60	0.60	0.55	Qwen s11	highest face score
HOUSE RULES	060	0.56	0.62	0.63	Qwen s202	highest face score
HOUSE RULES	070	0.41	0.53	0.45	Qwen s202	override
HOUSE RULES	080	0.53	0.64	0.63	Flux 2	override
HOUSE RULES	090	-	-	-	Flux 2	override
HOUSE RULES	100	0.62	0.68	0.66	Qwen s11	highest face score
HOUSE RULES	110	-	-	-	Qwen s11	no face to score - default
TEMPER	020	-	-	-	Qwen s11	no face to score - default
TEMPER	030	0.52	0.43	0.49	Flux 2	highest face score
TEMPER	040	-	-	-	Qwen s11	no face to score - default
TEMPER	050	0.63	0.75	0.71	Qwen s11	highest face score
TEMPER	060	0.44	0.70	0.68	Qwen s11	highest face score
TEMPER	070	-	-	-	Flux 2	override
TEMPER	080	0.57	0.67	0.70	Qwen s202	highest face score
TEMPER	090	0.46	0.45	0.63	Qwen s202	highest face score
TEMPER	100	-	-	-	Qwen s11	no face to score - default

Result. Where faces could be scored, Qwen-Image-2.1's better seed beat Flux 2 on 19 of 20 shots (mean +0.108). Its FIRST seed alone beat Flux on 17 of 20 (+0.083), so this is not the extra seed talking. Qwen draws a start frame in about 13 seconds against Flux 2's 33. Qwen-Image-2.1 is now the studio's default start-frame compositor (playbook \$0.3).

What the scores cannot see. Five start frames were overridden by eye: two between Qwen seeds (a stranger's hair intruding at the frame edge; an arm raised for the action), and three toward Flux 2 - every one for shot size. Asked for a close-up or an insert, Qwen tended to draw a medium shot with the whole person in it; Flux 2 kept to the framing. Qwen wins faces; Flux 2 still wins framing.

6 H3 against LTX-2.5, on the same frame and words

Nine shots were rendered on both engines from the same start frame with the same words, three seeds each, and the take that went in was picked by measurement and by eye. The face numbers are each engine's best take, scored against the shot's own start frame.

film	shot	H3 best face	LTX best face	in the cut	what decided it
DEAD STOCK	020 hiding	0.77	0.73	MiniMax H3	no faults, highest score 0.772
DEAD STOCK	050 the stack	0.62	0.47	MiniMax H3	no faults, highest score 0.622
DEAD STOCK	110 the other side	0.62	0.49	MiniMax H3	every take faulted; fewest faults (silent (-56 dB))
HOUSE RULES	100 he laughs	0.61	0.41	MiniMax H3	no faults, highest score 0.612
TEMPER	020 bellows	no face	no face	MiniMax H3	by eye over the ranker's h3:11 - two separate flares, one per pump, each dying before the next - the effect at
TEMPER	030 watching	0.64	0.47	MiniMax H3	no faults, highest score 0.641
TEMPER	050 first blow	0.62	0.45	MiniMax H3	no faults, highest score 0.625
TEMPER	070 quench	no face	no face	MiniMax H3	no faults, highest score 0.700
TEMPER	080 through the steam	0.65	0.51	MiniMax H3	no faults, highest score 0.653

Result. The H3 take went in on 9 of 9 shots. Where there was a face to score, H3's best take held it better than LTX-2.5's best by +0.14 on average, with a static camera where the LTX takes pushed in on close-ups that asked for stillness. On the two effects inserts in TEMPER the difference is visible without a number: the bellows gave two separate flares on H3, each dying before the next, where every LTX take grew the fire and kept it; the quench burst into steam that held low on H3, with the blade still visible, where every LTX take whited out the frame. LTX-2.5 stays the default - it is the only engine here that speaks a written line through a moving mouth, and it made every line in these films - but a held close-up and an effect that must clear belong on H3.

7 The Seedance notation - what we would have sent, and did not

Every shot below was rendered locally. For each: why the paid engine would do it better, and the exact prompt it would get, with [image 1] the shot's composed start frame, [image 2] the character's reference and [image 3] the place's plate. It runs through workflow 76 (Seedance 2.5, reference mode, 1080p) with one command once someone signs in to a Comfy account; the same text is in studio/samples/fight/SEEDANCE_NOTATION.md.

DEAD STOCK

030 the door - 5 s. A walk. Measured: our engines hold the picture and the person but not the walk itself - he takes one step and stops because we wrote it that way. Seedance would walk him the whole aisle.

[image 1] is the first frame. The man of [image 2] walks in out of the rain through the loading door of the warehouse of [image 3] and comes slowly down the long aisle toward the camera, unhurried, gloved hands loose at his sides, lamplight passing over him lamp by lamp until he stops ten metres from us. Static camera, anamorphic, night, sodium orange and blue shadow. Sound: rain roaring outside, the door on its rails, his footsteps on wet concrete getting closer. No music.

```
fight.py --sequence dead-stock --seedance 030 --resolution 1080p
```

070 the fall - 5 s. A physical event with dozens of bodies in contact. We choreographed it in Blender and drew it through depth control, so every crate lands where the simulation put it; Seedance would invent the physics from words - better texture at speed, no guarantee where anything lands.

[image 1] is the first frame: the warehouse of [image 3] with the man of [image 2] far down the aisle. A towering stack of old wooden crates beside the camera tips over and falls across the aisle; the crates crash onto the wet concrete, burst apart, tumble and pile up into a wall of broken wood that cuts the aisle in two, splinters and dust bursting into the orange lamplight, the man beyond it raising an arm. Camera low and static, slight shake at the impact. Sound: a long groan of wood, a thunderous crash, boards splintering, debris settling, rain. No music.

```
fight.py --sequence dead-stock --seedance 070 --resolution 1080p
```

080 the dust - 4 s. An effect that must arrive at an instant and then clear (the breakdown's rule 3). Measured: LTX lets dust accumulate whatever the words say; H3 plateaus and clears, which is why this shot is on H3. Seedance keys the effect to the impact frame.

[image 1] is the first frame. A wave of dust and splinters from the fallen crates hits the man of [image 2] at the instant it arrives - he flinches behind his raised arm - and in a second the air clears; he lowers the arm and squints through the last of it. Medium shot, static camera, the sodium lamp swinging above him. Sound: the dust's rush, debris pattering, his cough, rain. No music.

```
fight.py --sequence dead-stock --seedance 080 --resolution 1080p
```

Not shot: the sprint - 6 s. The obvious action beat - she runs the length of the aisle as the stack comes down behind her - is the one this box measurably cannot do (motion fidelity at speed). The script was written around it: she brings the stack down and is simply on the other side of it.

[image 1] is the woman of [image 2] at the foot of the crates in the warehouse of [image 3]. She sprints flat out down the aisle toward the camera as the tower of crates behind her tips and crashes down, splinters and dust chasing her, lamplight strobing over her as she passes under each lamp; she dives through the last gap as the crates close it. Camera tracking backward low and fast. Sound: her feet slapping wet concrete, her breath, the roar of falling crates. No music.

HOUSE RULES

030 the stranger - 5 s. The only candidate in this film, and a weak one: an entrance is a walk, and our engines hold the walker rather than the walk - so he is already inside when the shot begins. Dialogue, faces and a room at night are what this box does best; nothing else here needs paying for.

[image 1] is the first frame. The young man of [image 2] pushes the glass door of the diner of [image 3] open against the wind and steps in out of the rain, the bell jingling above him; he stops on the mat, dripping, and looks toward the counter. Static camera, medium shot, warm tungsten inside, blue rain and neon outside. Sound: the bell, a gust of rain, the door easing shut. No music.

```
fight.py --sequence house-rules --seedance 030 --resolution 1080p
```

TEMPER

050 first blow - 5 s. Sparks that exist at the instant of each blow and are gone before the next - the breakdown's rule 3, which we measured does not transfer to LTX-2.5 (the effect accumulates) and partly does to H3. This shot is rendered on both and picked; Seedance is the engine that keys an effect to an impact frame.

[image 1] is the first frame. The woman of [image 2] brings the hammer down on the glowing blade on the anvil of the forge of [image 3] three times in a steady rhythm; at the exact instant each blow lands a burst of white-orange sparks explodes off the steel and is gone before the hammer rises again; between the blows the air is clear. Medium shot, static camera, firelight and blue moonlight. Sound: three ringing clangs, each with the spit of sparks, the fire's roar. No music.

```
fight.py --sequence temper --seedance 050 --resolution 1080p
```

060 the rhythm - 10 s. Several angles on fast repeated strikes in one generation. LTX-2.5 does the cuts (measured: the word cut makes the cut, and the face holds when it is in the start frame) but not the speed of the swing; Seedance's 15-second multi-shot with references is built for exactly this.

[image 1] is the first frame. The woman of [image 2] works the glowing blade on the anvil of the forge of [image 3] in a fast, heavy rhythm. Shot one, medium: three hard blows, sparks bursting at each. Cut to shot two, an extreme close-up: the hammer face meeting the orange steel, sparks spraying at the lens. Cut to shot three, a close-up of her face in the firelight, eyes narrowed, sweat running. Cut to shot four, medium: she turns the blade with the tongs and brings the hammer down again. Sound: the ringing rhythm of the hammer, her breath, the fire's roar. No music.

```
fight.py --sequence temper --seedance 060 --resolution 1080p
```

070 quench - 4 s. A burst of steam at the instant of contact that must then roll away and clear - rule 3 again. Rendered here on H3 and LTX and picked.

[image 1] is the first frame. The glowing blade held by the woman of [image 2] plunges into the water trough of the forge of [image 3]; at the instant it touches, the water erupts into a violent boil and a burst of white steam, which rolls away and thins in a second to show the dark blade under the water. Insert close-up, static camera. Sound: a sharp angry hiss at the instant of contact, bubbling, then quiet. No music.

```
fight.py --sequence temper --seedance 070 --resolution 1080p
```

Not shot: the full forging, one take - 15 s. A whole forging in one continuous 15-second take - heat, strike, turn, strike, quench - is a chain of fast motions with effects at each instant. We cut it into one beat per shot, which is what this box does well; Seedance would attempt it in one.

[image 1] is the woman of [image 2] at the anvil of the forge of [image 3]. In one continuous take she draws the glowing blade from the coals, strikes it four times with sparks bursting at each blow, turns it, strikes twice more, then plunges it into the trough in an eruption of steam. Handheld camera circling her slowly. Sound: the fire, six ringing blows, the hiss of the quench. No music.

Price. Seedance 2.5's rate was not verified tonight. At the last rate verified here (Seedance 2.0 Fast, \$0.09 a second) the whole notation is about \$5 for one take of each, \$16 for three. The studio's rule for spending it (\$96.4): start frames before video, by scene not by shot, and a bought take must beat the local take on the same beat, scored by the same tools.

8 What was deliberately not used

tool	why not tonight
Seedance 2.5 (paid video)	No paid engines, by instruction. Section 6 is what it would have been handed.
Nano Banana 2 (paid start frames)	The local compositor was measured instead (section 5); the paid one has never been scored against it. Wired as workflow 85, switched off.
Wan Animate 2 (motion transfer)	It runs and transfers motion, but its identity through motion is unmeasured (the first wiring cropped the reference's head). Nothing enters a film on a look.
LTX Ingredients (reference sheet)	It carries the cast into a clip with no start frame, but adding it to a start frame lowered identity against the start frame alone (\$0.2). Not a route yet.
Krea 2 (look and style)	A look tool, measured once; the cast stage stays on Flux 2 until the three-engine casting test (queue item 22).
H3 reference-to-video	Carries identity but doubled the person in 2 of 4 renders (\$97.3).
Timecodes in prompts	Measured to do nothing on LTX-2.5; the word 'cut' makes the cut (\$95).

9 What it cost, in minutes

Wall-clock seconds of GPU work per stage, from the render logs, on one RTX 5090 with nothing paid for. The films were built between 02:00 and 09:00 on 2026-09-29.

stage	DEAD STOCK	HOUSE RULES	TEMPER	all three
cast and plate	0.8 min	0.7 min	0.3 min	1.8 min
physics shot (LTX-2.3)	3.7 min	-	-	3.7 min
start frames (Flux 2)	5.0 min	5.8 min	5.4 min	16.3 min
start frames (Qwen-2.1)	3.0 min	3.5 min	3.0 min	9.6 min
takes on H3	8.2 min	2.1 min	9.6 min	19.9 min
takes on LTX-2.5	9.4 min	11.0 min	10.6 min	31.0 min
total	30 min	23 min	29 min	82 min

Not counted: measuring and ranking takes, the music, the finish and the 2x master - a few minutes a film.

10 How to make them again

```
python3 studio/_tools/fight.py --sequence temper --cast
python3 studio/_tools/fight.py --sequence temper --anchors --compositor best --qseeds 11 202
python3 studio/_tools/fight.py --sequence temper --shots --seeds 11 202 3003
python3 studio/_tools/fight.py --sequence temper --h3 all --seeds 11 202 3003
python3 studio/_tools/previz_shot.py --sequence dead-stock --shot 070
python3 studio/_tools/fight.py --sequence temper --score
~/ComfyUI/venv/bin/python3 studio/_tools/take_rank.py --sequence temper
python3 studio/_tools/fight.py --sequence temper --music
python3 studio/_tools/fight.py --sequence temper --finish --master --picks "$(cat ../picks.txt)"
python3 studio/_tools/film_cards.py --sequence temper
python3 studio/_tools/seedance_notation.py
```

Or open <http://192.168.0.45:8777/shots> and press the stages in order. The shot scripts are studio/shotscripts/dead-stock.json, house-rules.json and temper.json.